

# An Investigation of Language Models Using Prompts

## Abstract

Large language models are powerful. We investigate them using prompts. We tried several prompts and report what happened. Our findings show that prompts matter.

## 1. Introduction

Language models such as GPT are widely used. Prompting is a technique where you give the model text. In this work we investigate prompting. This is an important topic because many people use prompts.

## 2. Related Work

Other people have studied prompting. We are aware of this literature.

## 3. Approach

We wrote ten prompts by hand. We gave the prompts to a language model. We looked at the outputs and judged whether they were good. One author did the judging. We did not define criteria in advance.

## 4. Findings

Some prompts produced better outputs than other prompts. Longer prompts sometimes helped. Shorter prompts sometimes helped too. It depends. We did not measure statistical significance because the sample was small.

## 5. Discussion

Our findings suggest prompts are important. This agrees with intuition. There are limitations: we used one model, ten prompts, and one annotator. We did not release our prompts.

## 6. Conclusion

Prompting matters. Future work should investigate further.